

Jeep, Nissan, Infiniti, Toyota, Lexus, Mitsubishi, Chevrolet and GMC, with every

bit of external detail recreated. The game runs you through a series of races and challenges, with a cash prize at the end of each, which you will need to upscale your truck and buy new components.

Its gameplay and physics are more of the 'hit and run' arcade style racing games but it makes for some very enjoyable racing action. There is little that you can do wrong with the controls and you would have to really push the vehicle to make it go belly up.

The game pits you against seven computer

AI opponents, none of whom is a pushover! You can expect a lot of fun trying to beat them and that will happen only when you've gained enough knowledge about the track. You can take as many shortcuts as you want but you can't go too far off track because you have to go through all the checkpoints on a track.

The game offers a rather interesting option called 'Free Roam', where the driver can tour maps alone. It has multiplayer support and you can compete against your pals on a LAN or on the Internet.

Genre: Sports/Simulation

Developer: Terminal Reality

Distributor: e-Xpress Interactive

Phone: 022-8870017

Web site: www.4x4evolution.com

Price: Rs 699

Rating: ★★★★★



OFFROAD ACTION: An arcade style racing game that will have you ploughing dirt at your opponents

SERIOUS SAM: THE SECOND ENCOUNTER

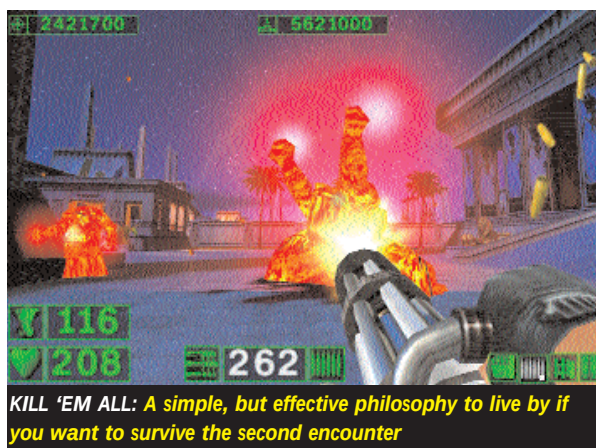
Seriously Fun

About a year ago, Croteam, an unknown garage development team from Croatia released the surprise hit of 2001. Hailing back to the formula of *DOOM*, this game was welcomed by everyone for its wafer-thin plot, tongue-in-cheek humour, and run-and-gun gameplay. The colourful and bright settings and graphical eye candy made it a real blast to play. Croteam now serves up another dose of adrenaline with *Serious Sam: The Second Encounter*.

This time, Sam Stone has some new enemies and new guns in a whole new setting (you explore Mayan, Babylonian, and Medieval lands). We could tell you more about the story, but that's hardly the point. Rest assured, you will have a lot of Mental's Minions to kill. *The Second Encounter* (*TSE*) builds on the ideas laid out in the original by adding more things to shoot at, more levels, more wacky secrets, and more of that unique humour that has become a trademark of the original.

If you haven't played *Serious Sam 1*, you're in for a visual treat. The Serious Engine is just amazing. Glorious lighting, gigantic levels, bright colours, and hundreds of enemies on the screen at once—with no drop in frame rates! No one else has attempted to create a game with such wide, open areas and locations since the first *Serious Sam*.

There are four new weapons for *TSE*:



KILL 'EM ALL: A simple, but effective philosophy to live by if you want to survive the second encounter

the Chainsaw, Sniper Rifle, Flame Thrower, and Serious Bomb, in addition to all the fun weapons from the first game. The gameplay usually revolves around getting a gun and killing things. Get a bigger gun, and kill some more. You'll be hunting for switches and/or objects to open doors but unlike *Quake*, you'll be warding off hundreds of monsters at the same time. There's a bit of puzzle solving involved too and the level design will test your reflexes as well as your brain.

There's nothing like the scream of a Kamikaze coming from far off to send waves of panic through you. Or having a 50-foot tall Mechanoid shoot rockets at you. The sound effects have been done exceedingly well, considering the budget Croteam would have been working with.

Extra points for the background music, which switches to Metal/Industrial mode when the enemies appear up and close.

There's a whole bunch of multiplayer options that come with this game—LAN, Internet (Gamespy), or Co-operative Deathmatch. You also get some really cool mods for multiplayer, such as *Seriously Warped Deathmatch*, *Scorematch*, *Co-operative*, *Fragmatch*, *Thief*,

Rugby, *Teamplay* and *Capture the Flag*, all of which are bundled with the game.

While all the other shooters out there are trying hard to be realistic, *Serious Sam* tries to make the game as much fun as possible. And fun is what you get. For Rs 699, *TSE* gives you single player, co-operative, multiplayer, and other gameplay modes, which will keep you busy for a long time. If you have a decent PC with a 3D graphics card yearning to be pushed, go get this game.

Genre: First Person Shooter

Developer: Croteam

Distributor: e-Xpress Interactive

Phone: 022-8870017

Web site: www.croteam.com

Price: Rs 699

Rating: ★★★★★